

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Noorjahan Abdul

Address: Apartment 13 Sovereign Apartments 328 High Street Sutton SM1 1AP

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am a resident of Sutton and have known the group running these community support programmes for many years. I am writing to express my strong support for this planning application.

The programmes they provide are vital to our local community. Their core focus is bringing people together, helping neighbours get to know one another, and encouraging mutual support. For many elderly residents, these gatherings feel like a second home. They offer a welcoming space to meet friends, reduce isolation, and maintain meaningful social connections, which is incredibly important for their wellbeing.

Children and young people are also actively involved in community service activities through these programmes. This involvement fosters a strong sense of responsibility, respect, and contribution to the wider community from an early age.

In addition, the group organises health and fitness classes, which are particularly beneficial for women. These sessions provide not only physical health benefits but also a safe and supportive environment where participants feel comfortable attending classes and engaging openly with people they know and trust.

It is important to emphasise that this group has been running classes and community programmes in the same area for a considerable time, hiring the local church hall. Therefore, this is not a new or unfamiliar activity, despite concerns that may have been raised. Their presence has been consistent, responsible, and positively received by many residents.

Granting this approval would ensure the continuation of a safe, inclusive space that strengthens community cohesion. The centre also has plans to organise integration tours and community-wide programmes open to all local residents. These initiatives will further promote understanding, inclusivity, and fraternity within the Sutton community.

For these reasons, I strongly support this application and believe it will bring lasting social value to the area.